



Figure 1: JS template engine

You can also download the JS file from the site <http://underscorejs.org>. In the following sample code, let's download and use the *Minified* form of JS library.

Basic usage

There are three types of tags available on the Underscore template.

1. *interpolate* `<%= ... %>`

This prints the contents of the variable or the result of the expression presented inside the tag.

2. *evaluate* `<% ... %>`

This interprets the JavaScript statements available inside the tag, by which we can provide logical structure to the template.

3. *escape* `<%= ... %>`

This is similar to interpolate but escapes the following characters: `&`, `<`, `>`, `"`, `'`, and `/`

Let's now look at how the above tags are used. I am using an Apache Web server and I keep the following HTML, JS and library files under the directory *undertemp*, which is under the *webroot* directory.

Figure 2 gives a very simple example that shows you the details of how to use a template.

index.html

```

1 <head>
2   <meta charset="UTF-8">
3   <title>Underscore Template sample</title>
4 </head>
5
6 <body>
7
8 <script type="text/template" class="students-list-
  template">
9 <%= ...each( listItems, function( listItem ){ %>
10   <li>
11     <%= listItem.name %>
12     <%= if ( listItem.mark >30 ){
13       print('<em>Pass</em>');
14     } else {
15       print('<em>Fail</em>');
16     } %>
17   </li>
18 <%= }}; %>
19 </script>
20
```

```

21 <script src="jquery-2.1.3.min.js"></script>
22 <script src="underscore-min.js"></script>
23 <script src="view.js"></script>
24 <header> </header>
25 <section> </section>
26 <div id="students"> </div>
27 </body>
28 </html>

```

view.js

```

1 $( document ).ready(function() {
2
3   var tpl = _.template("<h1>Hello <%= course %> students</
  h1>");
4   var tplString = tpl({course: "MBA"});
5   $("header").html(tplString);
6
7   var stuData = {
8     listItems: [
9       {
10         name: "Kavi",mark: 89
11       },
12       {
13         name: "Aarthi",mark: 78
14       },
15       {
16         name: "Bala",mark: 15
17       },
18       {
19         name: "Shrini",mark: 45
20       }
21     ]
22   };
23
24   var tpl1 = _.template($("#students-list-template").
  html());
25   var tplString1 = tpl1(stuData);
26   $("#students").html(tplString1);
27 });

```

index.html: An explanation

- We use the *Jquery* library for DOM manipulation. So the *Jquery* library has been included in Line 21.
- Lines 8-19 define the template inside the script tag with type as *text/template*. JavaScript does not interpret this content. We can retrieve the content by using the following *Jquery* class based selector:

```
$("#students-list-template").html()
```

This template uses the *escape* and *evaluate* tags.

- By using the escape tag `<%= listItem.name %>`, it prints the name after performing the *escape* function on it.